
Meeting assets for Audel & Andy SDRT are ready!

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Meeting assets for Audel & Andy SDRT are ready!

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Meeting summary

Key takeaways

- Andy is in his second week of retirement and staying busy with personal projects, helping others, and physical activities like hiking
- Andy completed a week-long trauma seminar by Alex Howard through the Institute of Noetic Sciences, learning the ECHO and REST models for trauma processing
- Andy's daughter Ryan entered rehab for substance abuse issues, which Andy hopes will help her address her fear-based patterns
- Both participants engaged in a 15-minute meditation session together, with Audel experiencing a sense of peace and release
- Andy will share his detailed notes and recordings from the trauma seminar with Audel
- Audel's school year ends May 22nd, and he will be doing summer school counseling at a middle school from May 26th through July 1st

Discussed topics

Retirement transition and daily activities

Andy shared updates about his early retirement experience, noting he's been busier than expected with various activities and responsibilities.

- **Details**
 - Andy(he/him): Helping an elderly gentleman who broke his hip with tasks like paying bills and navigating Social Security
 - Andy(he/him): Increased physical activity including hiking at Mount Tam and visiting lakes in the Marin Watershed
 - Andy(he/him): Attending AA meetings again after a 2-year break, using them as meditation practice
 - Andy(he/him): Planning to attend Buddhist teacher events including a Posca Day ceremony for renewing precepts
 - Andy(he/him): Dealing with financial matters including an overpayment from his former company that he reported honestly
- **Conclusion**





- Andy is actively filling his retirement time with meaningful activities and community engagement
- The transition is still unsettled but he has plans for different financial scenarios

Platform and budget consolidation

Andy discussed switching video conferencing platforms due to cost considerations.

- **Details**
 - Andy(he/him): Consolidating costs by switching from preferred platform to Google Meet
 - Andy(he/him): Adjusting to budget constraints in retirement
- **Conclusion**
 - Both participants are flexible and willing to adapt to platform changes

Trauma seminar and healing models

Andy provided extensive details about a week-long trauma course he completed through the Institute of Noetic Sciences.

- **Details**
 - Andy(he/him): Completed free seminar led by Alex Howard, British author of "It's Not Your Fault: Why Childhood Trauma Shapes You and How to Break Free"
 - Andy(he/him): Learned the ECHO model - Events, Context, Homeostatic shift, Outcomes - describing how trauma creates filters for life experiences
 - Andy(he/him): Studied the REST model - Recognize system state, Examine how state is created, Stop unhelpful thought patterns, Emotions (connect to process and heal), Transformation of relationship to self and body
 - Andy(he/him): Compared REST model to the mindfulness RAIN technique, noting similarities
 - Andy(he/him): Observed participants holding onto trauma from others' bad behavior without developing self-awareness and self-compassion
 - Andy(he/him): Emphasized that healing starts with awareness and paying attention
 - Audel: Expressed strong interest in receiving the materials
- **Conclusion**
 - The seminar reinforced mindfulness principles Andy already practices
 - Awareness is the essential first step in trauma healing
 - Many people struggle to move beyond identifying their trauma to actually processing it

Buddhist teachings and compassion

Audel shared insights from Pema Chödrön videos he recently watched.

- **Details**
 - Audel: Discovered Pema Chödrön content through YouTube algorithm
 - Audel: Learned that compassion hurts when practiced correctly because of raw tenderness and full feeling without resistance
 - Audel: Discussed monastic practice of taking fearless inventory twice monthly during moon changes
 - Audel: Shared teaching about not adding onto experiences, not making problems out of problems
 - Andy(he/him): Confirmed Abhayagiri monastery name means "Fearless Mountain"
 - Andy(he/him): Acknowledged that recognizing when we make problems out of problems is part of the practice
- **Conclusion**
 - True compassion involves feeling pain fully without resistance
 - Regular fearless inventory helps practitioners turn toward fear rather than away from it
 - The practice allows people to stop and observe without adding unnecessary layers

Family situation and daughter's rehab

Andy shared that his daughter Ryan entered rehabilitation treatment.

- **Details**
 - Andy(he/him): Ryan has been fear-based since early childhood, citing example of being afraid garbage truck would "bite" her at age 2-3





- Andy(he/him): Ryan entered rehab facility in Auburn, California in the foothills
- Andy(he/him): Facility offers equestrian therapy with horses
- Andy(he/him): Concerned Ryan is worried about her husband instead of focusing on her own recovery
- Andy(he/him): Hopes she will surrender to the process rather than remain fear-based
- Audel: Expressed hope for Ryan's recovery and noted the difficulty of the situation
- **Conclusion**
 - This may not be Ryan's only rehab experience but it's an important step
 - Andy is concerned about Ryan's tendency to focus on others rather than herself
 - The facility appears to be a quality treatment center with comprehensive programming

Hawaii trip reflections

Andy reflected on lessons learned from a recent Hawaii vacation.

- **Details**
 - Andy(he/him): Noticed the slower "island pace" with single-lane roads and speed limit driving
 - Andy(he/him): Experienced getting stressed about parking/navigation and received "hang ten" gesture from local to relax
 - Andy(he/him): Recognized the message to slow down and chill out
 - Audel: Has not been to Hawaii
- **Conclusion**
 - The Hawaii experience reinforced lessons about slowing down and reducing stress
 - Andy is working to carry these lessons into retirement life

Personal trauma and healing journey

Andy discussed his own experiences with trauma processing and anxiety.

- **Details**
 - Andy(he/him): Recalled shutting down mentally during arguments with ex-wife as a protection mechanism
 - Andy(he/him): Takes opposite approach now by exposing and examining difficult experiences
 - Andy(he/him): Initially re-traumatized himself when first dealing with anxiety
 - Andy(he/him): Eventually changed his relationship with anxiety through continued practice
 - Andy(he/him): Noted many people avoid facing things they don't like
- **Conclusion**
 - Andy's approach of facing difficulties directly has helped him overcome anxiety
 - The journey involved setbacks including re-traumatization before finding healing
 - Exposure and examination, rather than avoidance, proved effective for Andy

Meditation practice

Both participants completed a meditation session together during the meeting.

- **Details**
 - Andy(he/him): Experienced technical difficulties accessing Insight Timer app due to interface changes
 - Andy(he/him): Set timer for meditation session
 - Audel: Experienced a sense of peace and release during meditation
 - Audel: Realized how much tension he was holding and felt relief letting it go
 - Andy(he/him): Described feeling unsettled during his meditation
 - Andy(he/him): Noted that not feeling peaceful during meditation is also okay and valid
- **Conclusion**
 - Meditation experiences vary and all states are acceptable
 - The practice provided Audel with needed release and peace
 - Regular practice helps recognize the "noise floor" of daily life

Summer schedule planning

Audel shared his plans for the end of the school year and summer.

- **Details**
 - Audel: Last day of regular school year is May 22nd





- Audel: Will do summer school counseling starting May 26th
- Audel: Summer position is at a middle school (different from his regular high school)
- Audel: Summer school runs through July 1st with half-day sessions
- Audel: Doing summer work to stay busy and earn extra money
- Andy(he/him): Noted summer school students often don't want to be there
- **Conclusion**
 - Audel will have a brief break before summer school begins
 - Half-day format makes summer work less stressful
 - Audel will be finished with all work by early July

June schedule adjustments

Both participants reviewed and adjusted their June meeting schedule.

- **Details**
 - Andy(he/him): Traveling to Joshua Tree June 2nd-8th, requiring cancellation of June 8th meeting
 - Andy(he/him): Trip involves 8-hour drive each way, possibly 12 hours with sightseeing
 - Audel: Canceled June 29th meeting
 - Both: Confirmed June 1st meeting remains scheduled
- **Conclusion**
 - Two June meetings were canceled due to travel and scheduling conflicts
 - Participants will maintain their regular Monday meeting on June 1st

Challenges

- Andy navigating financial uncertainty in early retirement while waiting for final resolution of company overpayment situation
- Andy's daughter Ryan struggling with fear-based patterns while entering rehab, with concerns about her focusing on husband rather than her own recovery
- Insight Timer app interface changes making it difficult to access basic meditation timer functionality
- Summer school students typically not wanting to be present, creating potential challenges for Audel's counseling work

Action items

- **Andy(he/him)**
 - Send Audel detailed notes from the trauma seminar (tomorrow morning)
 - Package and send recordings from the trauma seminar as a zip file to Audel (tomorrow morning)
 - Attend Buddhist teacher Ajahn Pasanno's event in Berkeley (tomorrow)
 - Participate in Posca Day ceremony for renewal of precepts (Saturday)
 - Consider finding alternative to Insight Timer app due to interface issues
- **Audel**
 - Complete remaining school year responsibilities (through May 22nd)
 - Begin summer school counseling at middle school (May 26th through July 1st)

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